



Peter Ilyich Tchaikovsky (1840–1893)

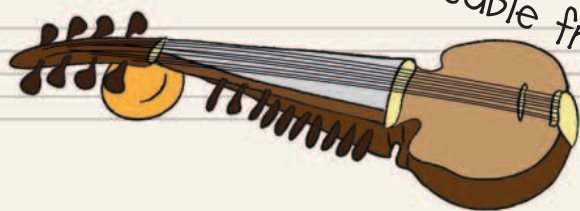
Russian composer Tchaikovsky began piano lessons when he was five and could **read music better than his dad** by the time he was eight. His ballet *The Nutcracker* is a winter holiday favorite, and *Swan Lake* remains popular.

Ali Akbar Khan (1922–2009)

This Indian musician thought six-string guitars were for wimps, so he played an Indian version, called a **SAROD** that had 25 strings! He was the **court musician for a Maharaja**, and was credited with bringing Indian music to attention of the world.



Unlike a guitar, a sarod has moveable frets



Toru Takemitsu (1930–1996)

This **SELF-TAUGHT** Japanese musician and composer brought together jazz, popular music, western classical music, and Asian music. He composed the score for more than **90 Japanese films**, but is better known in the Western world as a classical composer.